

Organizational Behavior and Quality

Week 1: What Is Organizational Behavior?

People behavior → quality outcomes

Week 1 Lecture: What Is Organizational Behavior?

Postgraduate Diploma in Total Quality Management

Based on Robbins & Judge, Organizational Behavior, 18th ed.
Designed for active, case-based postgraduate learning

OB

individuals • groups • structure



**quality
outcomes**

Dr. Abdelmutalab Adam

Learning Outcomes

Explain

Define organizational behavior and explain why interpersonal skills matter for managerial effectiveness.

Differentiate

Distinguish management functions, roles, and technical, human, and conceptual skills.

Apply

Diagnose a quality-related problem at the individual, group, and organizational levels.

Evaluate

Explain systematic study, evidence-based management, and the disciplines contributing to OB.

Apply

Apply the inputs–processes–outcomes model to connect behavior with quality performance and evaluate feasible interventions.

Guiding question: How can understanding behavior improve quality performance?

Opening Case: When Quality Problems Are Human Problems

A hospital introduced a new electronic incident-reporting system. The technology worked, but reporting remained low. Staff feared blame, supervisors discouraged “bad news,” and departments argued over responsibility. The quality office concluded that the problem was not primarily technical—it was behavioral and organizational.

Discuss

What individual factors may be involved?
What group dynamics may be involved?
What organizational conditions may be involved?
What quality outcomes are affected?

Key insight

Many quality failures are produced by attitudes, norms, leadership, communication, structure, and culture—not by process design alone.

Teaching move

Ask learners to classify each cause at the individual, group, or organizational level.

Core idea: Quality systems succeed when human behavior reinforces them.

Why Interpersonal Skills Matter

Managers achieve results through other people.
Workplace relationships influence job satisfaction, stress, commitment, and turnover.
Human skills help organizations attract, develop, and retain high-performing employees.
A positive work environment supports engagement, learning, and responsible behavior.

Quality connection

Quality is delivered through human interactions: handoffs, teamwork, communication, judgement, and response to customers.

Prompt

Which people skill is most critical in your work context?

Managers and Organizations

Manager

An individual who achieves goals through other people. Managers make decisions, allocate resources, and direct activities toward goals.

Organization

A consciously coordinated social unit of two or more people that functions continuously to achieve common goals.

Quality is produced by people coordinated toward shared standards and improvement goals.

Examples: hospitals • universities • government agencies • manufacturing firms • service firms • nonprofits

Four Management Functions Through a Quality Lens

1 Planning

Set quality objectives, strategies and improvement priorities.

2 Organizing

Assign responsibilities, define process ownership and reporting lines.

3 Leading

Motivate, communicate, coach and resolve conflicts around quality work.

4 Controlling

Monitor performance, compare with targets and correct deviations.

Applied question: Which function is weakest when quality problems remain unresolved?

Mintzberg's Managerial Roles

Interpersonal

Figurehead • Leader • Liaison

Quality examples

Sponsor improvement teams, build trust, model standards, connect departments.

Informational

Monitor • Disseminator • Spokesperson

Quality examples

Review performance data, communicate lessons learned, report results to stakeholders.

Decisional

Entrepreneur • Disturbance handler • Resource allocator • Negotiator

Quality examples

Launch improvements, resolve failures, allocate resources, negotiate priorities.

A quality manager connects people, interprets data and allocates attention to improvement.

Three Essential Managerial Skills

Technical

Apply specialized knowledge or expertise.

Examples:

Process mapping • data analysis • audit methods • service design

Human

Understand, communicate with, motivate, and support people.

Examples:

Feedback • facilitation • conflict management

Conceptual

Analyze complex situations and choose among alternatives.

Examples:

Systems thinking • root-cause logic • strategic alignment

Reflection: Which skill is most developed in your current role—and which most limits your quality impact?

Effective vs. Successful Managers

Promotion speed and performance effectiveness may depend on different activities.

Activity	Average	Effective	Successful
Traditional management	32%	13%	28%
Communication	29%	44%	11%
Human resource management	20%	26%	11%
Networking	19%	11%	48%

Quality implication

Effective quality leadership requires strong communication and people management—not only visibility or networking.

Discussion

What does your organization reward: real effectiveness or visible success?

Direct takeaway: protect time for communication routines that surface accurate quality information.

What Is Organizational Behavior?

Organizational behavior is a field of study that investigates the impact of individuals, groups, and structure on behavior within organizations, with the purpose of applying that knowledge to improve organizational effectiveness.

Individuals

Attitudes, personality, perception, motivation, emotions, decisions.

Groups

Roles, norms, teams, communication, leadership, power, conflict.

Organization

Structure, culture, HR practices, and change.

TQM link: OB topics explain how quality practices become daily behavior.

From Intuition to Evidence-Based Management

- 1 Intuition**

Instinctive feelings and experience can be useful—but may be incomplete, biased, or overconfident.

- 2 Systematic study**

Examine relationships, seek causes and effects, and draw conclusions from rigorously gathered evidence.

- 3 Evidence-based management**

Make decisions using the best available scientific evidence, contextual information, and professional judgement.

Quality practice: Move from “I think the problem is...” to “What does the evidence suggest?”

Disciplines That Contribute to Organizational Behavior

Psychology

Learning • motivation • personality • emotions • perception • stress

Social psychology

Attitude change • communication • trust • group behavior • conflict

Sociology

Groups • structure • technology • communication • power • change

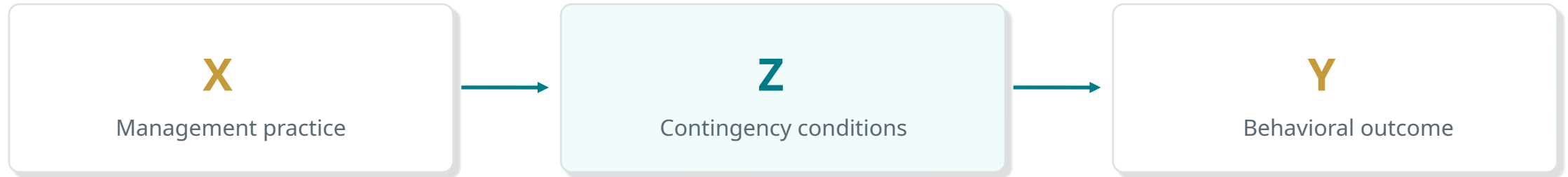
Anthropology

Values • culture • cross-cultural differences • organizational climate

Quality problems are rarely one-dimensional; use multiple disciplines to diagnose them.

Few Absolutes: The Contingency Perspective

Human behavior is complex and context dependent.



The same intervention may affect different people differently.
The same person may respond differently across situations.
Good diagnosis requires context, culture, task, people, and timing.

Do not copy practices blindly; diagnose the context first.

Managerial Challenges and Opportunities

Globalization

Workforce diversity

Customer service

Ethics

Digital & networked work

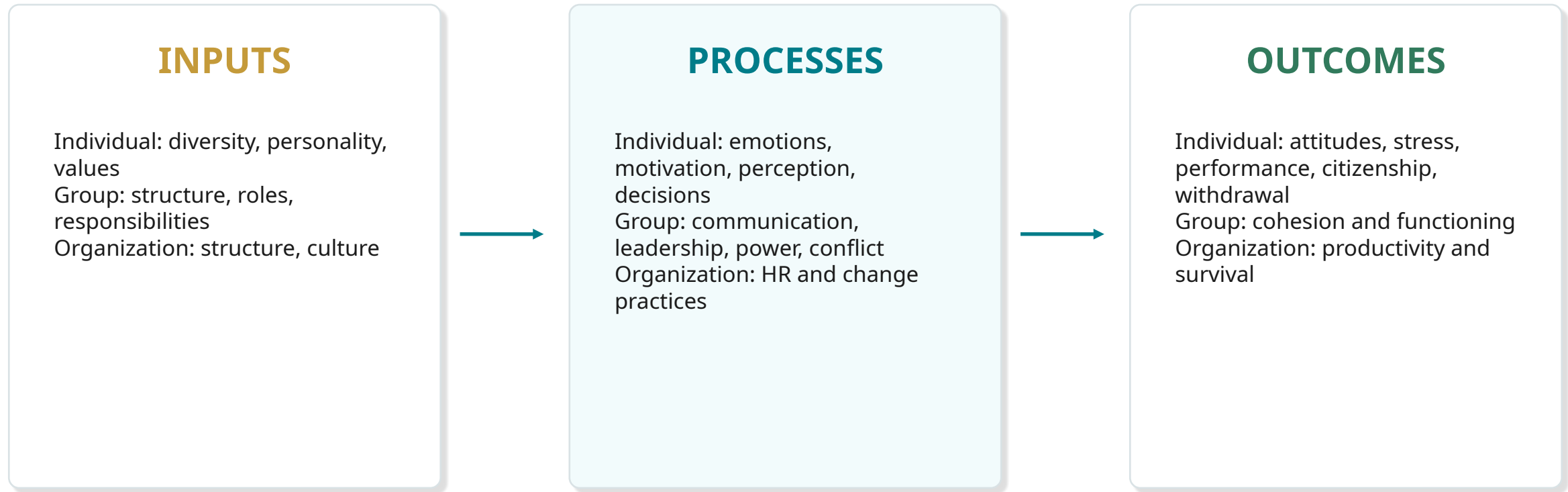
Employee well-being

Positive work environment

Quality leadership requires balancing performance, people, ethics, and adaptability.

Applied prompt: Which challenge is most visible in your organization today, and how does it affect quality?

A Basic Organizational Behavior Model



Feedback matters: outcomes change future inputs.

Applying the OB Model to Quality Performance

Level	Inputs	Behavioral processes	Quality outcomes
Individual	Knowledge, values, attitudes, emotions, motivation	Following standards, reporting errors, service behavior	Task quality, safety, customer experience
Group	Roles, norms, diversity, team responsibilities	Communication, coordination, conflict, team learning	Handover quality, problem solving, cohesion
Organization	Structure, culture, leadership system, HR practices	Resource allocation, change, recognition, governance	Productivity, reliability, improvement, sustainability

Diagnostic rule: Do not treat every quality problem as a process problem. Identify the behavioral level and mechanism.

In-Class Activity: Three-Level Diagnosis

Scenario

A university receives repeated complaints about slow student services. Staff say procedures are unclear; supervisors blame employee attitude; employees blame workload and poor systems; departments do not share information.

Deliverable

One-page diagnostic map: Inputs → Processes → Outcomes. Prepare a 2-minute explanation and defend your prioritization.

- 1 List at least six possible causes.
- 2 Classify each as individual, group, or organizational.
- 3 Identify relevant processes.
- 4 Select two priority interventions and justify their sequence.
- 5 Propose two indicators for monitoring improvement.

Small groups • 20 minutes • Applied to quality performance

Debrief Questions

1 Which causes were easiest to see? Which were initially overlooked?

2 Did the group overemphasize individual blame or organizational systems?

3 Which intervention would produce the fastest improvement?

4 Which intervention would produce the most sustainable improvement?

5 What evidence would you collect before making a final decision?

6 How would you measure the quality outcome?

Facilitator note: Push learners to distinguish symptoms, causes, mechanisms, and outcomes.

Mini Case: Reporting Errors Without Fear

A logistics company's quality unit introduced a "zero-defect" target. Managers praised teams with no reported errors. Within three months, formal error reports fell sharply, yet customer complaints and rework increased. Interviews suggested that employees had learned not to report problems because reporting damaged team reputation and triggered blame.

Core lesson: A metric can change behavior in ways that damage the real quality objective.

What individual attitudes or perceptions may explain the behavior?
What group norms and leadership signals reinforced under-reporting?
How should the performance and recognition system be redesigned?

Quality principle: A system that hides errors cannot learn from them.

Knowledge Check

Answer individually, then compare with a partner.

- 1 Organizational behavior focuses on individuals, groups, and _____.
- 2 Which managerial skill is the ability to understand and motivate people?
- 3 What approach bases managerial decisions on the best available scientific evidence?
- 4 Communication made the largest relative contribution among effective managers: True or False?
- 5 Give one example of an organizational-level input that can influence quality outcomes.

Suggested time: 5 minutes • Use as an exit ticket or Google Forms quiz.

Week 1 Assignment: OB–Quality Diagnostic Note

Task

**Select one real or familiar quality-related problem.
Write a 600–800 word diagnostic note that:**

Describe the problem and affected stakeholders.
Classify causes at individual, group, and organizational levels.
Apply the inputs–processes–outcomes model.
Identify evidence needed before action.
Recommend two feasible interventions.
Propose two indicators for monitoring improvement.

Assessment criteria

Conceptual accuracy – 30%
Quality of diagnosis – 30%
Application to quality – 20%
Evidence and feasibility – 10%
Clarity and professionalism – 10%

Submission

Individual work • Submit through Google Classroom • Use headings and concise evidence • Do not disclose confidential names or data

Key Takeaways

1

Organizational performance depends on how people behave—not only on formal processes.

2

Managers require technical, human, and conceptual skills.

3

Evidence should inform managerial judgement and reduce bias.

4

Behavior must be analyzed at individual, group, and organizational levels.

5

Inputs shape processes, and processes shape outcomes.

6

Quality interventions are stronger when behavioral causes are diagnosed explicitly.

Next week: Diversity in Organizations

Reference and Preparation for Next Session

Primary reference

**Robbins, S. P., & Judge, T. A. (2019).
Organizational Behavior (18th ed.). Pearson.**

Chapter 1 completed

What Is Organizational Behavior?

Prepare for Week 2

Read Chapter 2: Diversity in Organizations.
Identify one example of surface-level diversity and
one example of deep-level diversity.
Reflect on how bias or inclusion can influence
quality decisions.

Thank you